

6.2 Defining Member Functions

As we can see, member functions can be defined in two places - outside, and within the class definition. Consider the case where the member function is defined outside the class definition. A member function should always be defined separately outside a class, if its prototype is declared inside a class. There is an important difference between a member function and a normal function. A member function has an identity label in its header that tells the compiler which class the function belongs to.

Normally, a member function is defined as follows:

```
return-type class-name :: function-name (argument declaration)
{
    function body
}
```

Consider the following section of code.

```
void OurClass :: get_data( int k, int n)
{
    number = k;
    cost = n;
}

void OurClass :: put_data( void)
{
    cout <<" Number : " << number <<"\n";
    cout << "cost : " << cost <<"\n";
}
```

Here, `get_data` and `put_data` are two member functions of the class `OurClass`. Neither return any value, and hence their return type is `void`. `::` is known as the scope resolution operator as discussed above. A member function can also be defined by replacing the function declaration with the actual function definition within the class.